



Unreal II — The Awakening

A sight for sore eyes

Some games such as *Half-Life*, bring with them a solid plot. Others, such as the *NOLF* series, bring a twisted sense of humour, not to mention excellent gameplay. Still others, such as *Serious Sam: The Second Encounter*, are merely a demonstration of an engine's capability. *Unreal II* brings with it bags full of fun.

The Awakening, is at its very essence, a game that has been wrapped around a fabulous graphic engine. The story uses every clichéd word in the handbook, there's nothing new in the gameplay, and AI is practically non-existent. And yet, somehow they all come together and provide just that right amount of entertainment.

You are John Dalton, a space marshal relegated to a life of patrolling the back of beyond. Life just couldn't get any duller, when suddenly, you receive a distress signal from a void, plunging you headlong into a struggle for the existence of humanity. You



are ably supported on your perilous journeys by the beautiful and mysterious Aida, laid-back technician Isaak and a half-wit alien pilot called Ne'Ban.

The story unfolds in bits, and your object is to collect seven alien artefacts that hold immense power. The search for these artefacts will take you across diverse alien planets, breathtakingly rendered by the

game. You'll face stiff opposition from alien races and greedy corporations, that command fierce mercenary armies.

The strength of the *Unreal II* engine, is its ability to draw the great outdoors, with surreal alien environments forming its finest work. Combine this with the superb soundtrack, and you'll find that *Unreal II* is the ultimate food for your senses.

The AI is anything but intelligent, and the evil minions compensate for their stupidity, with brute force, agility and a kamikaze mentality. Most fight sequences are pretty mundane, except for those where you can use the sniper rifle, to take out the tons of bad guys, or when you team up with a squad of marines, and go head-to-head against the nasties.

Veteran players will find *Unreal II* a disappointment in terms of innovation. However, in terms of pure entertainment value, *Unreal II* delivers the goods. And how!

Genre: FPS ■ **Developer:** Legend Entertainment ■ **Publisher:** Epic Games Inc ■ **Distributor:** Milestone Interactive Software Ltd ■ **Phone:** 022-28381614
Website: www.unreal2.com ■ **Price:** Rs 1,299 ■ **System Requirements:** AMD or Intel 733 MHz CPU, 256 MB RAM, GeForce2 MX, 3 GB hard disk space ■ **Rating:** ★★★★★



Red Hat Linux Firewalls

Freshers kindly excuse

Red Hat Linux Firewalls delivers what the name suggests—information that a Red Hat Linux administrator needs to build an effective firewall. This book is for the guys in the trenches, who actually build and implement Linux firewalls.

The first chapter explains the significance of a firewall, types and threats. Next, comes the all-important TCP/IP primer. Chapter 2 takes the quick and dirty route to defining addressing, terms and services in TCP/IP to refresh the mind of what is, most likely, an already educated reader.

The chapter goes on to explain the use of popular TCP/IP tools such as ping and traceroute, as well as tools that may be platform-dependent, such as ifconfig and route. If you're coming over to the Linux fold from another unix-like OS, some tools may have unfamiliar usages,

but are still fairly easy to understand. Linux-specific TCP/IP configuration is covered, with important files, and their formats and instructions on how to modify configurations.

Design and implementation of a firewall is covered extensively, including popular tools, such as IPchains, IPTables, the TIS toolkit and the industry heavyweight CheckPoint, as well as hardware products. While not a full feature comparison of the tools, it makes for a good reference.

IPchains has been the mainstay of many Linux-based firewalls, simply because it was the only included choice in most Linux distributions. With kernel



updates came IPTables—a stateful firewall engine. However, the reality is that lots of folk still use IPchains for simplicity and compatibility. Chapter 7 is dedicated to IPchains firewalls, but stops short at implementing a simple firewall and administering it.

The book is a lot more verbose with IPTables, with three chapters dedicated to the basics, implementation and advanced facilities. It wraps up with a few chapters on design, administration and testing, not to forget, appendices. Appendix E is worthy of note for including sample firewall scripts.

In all, the book is recommended for experienced Linux folk. Not recommended if you plan to try out the sample scripts on your server over a telnet connection.

Publisher: Red Hat Press ■ **Author:** Bill McCarty ■ **Distributor:** Wiley-dreamtech India Pvt Ltd ■ **Phone:** 011-23275895, 23270877
Fax: 011-23275895 ■ **E-mail:** wdt@vsnl.net ■ **Web site:** www.wileydreamtech.com ■ **Price:** Rs 329
Rating: ★★★★★